INTERSECONDARY SCHOOLS EXAMINATION SERIES
ISESE

FORM FOUR MONTHLY TEST
ENGLISH LANGUAGE

TIME: 3 HOURS **JULY 2025**

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. This paper consists of section A, B, and C.
2. Answer all questions in section A, and B; and any TWO questions in section C
3. Phones and calculator devices are strictly prohibited in the examination room.
4. Write your appropriate Examination Number on every page of your answer booklet(s).

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SECTION A (16 Marks)

Answer **all** questions from this section

1. For each of the items (i)-(x) choose the most correct answer from among the given alternatives and write its letter beside the item number in the answer booklet provided

i. The word *probably* in the sentence, "All students will probably pass their pre-mock exams this year," indicates that the information is uncertain. What is the function of the word *probably* in this sentence?

A. To express certainty

B. To express ability

C. To express uncertainty

D. To express obligation

E. To express futurity

ii. Choose the correct phrase to complete the sentence:

"The door was opened _____, so I was able to see them when they were dancing Singeli song."

A. Little

B. A little

C. Few

D. A few

E. Least

iii. Aisha checked her watch and saw that the time was 03:40 PM. How should she correctly express this time in words?

A. It is three o'clock past forty

B. It is forty minutes past nine

C. It is twenty minutes to ten

D. It is three past twenty

E. It is twenty minutes to four

iv. The sentence "Seldom did Anna wear shoes" suggests that Anna wore shoes only on rare occasions. What does this sentence mean?

A. Anna wore shoes frequently

B. Anna will never wear shoes

C. Anna never wears shoes

D. Anna wore shoes rarely

E. Anna does not wear shoes

v. On his wedding day, my brother Jongo looked very smart. He told me that instead of calling him *brother*, I should refer to him as a _____.

A. Bachelor

B. Best man

C. Gloom

D. Bride

E. Groom

vi. Choose the correct verb to complete the sentence below:

"Neither Joseph Kon nor his wife Rebecca Juju _____ around when Taifa Stars was playing."

A. Was

B. Were

C. Where

D. Is

E. Who

vii. The word *adjacent* in the sentence "Montfort Secondary School is adjacent to Luhoho Hospital" has a similar meaning to which of the following words?

A. Opposite

B. Near

C. Next

D. Close

E. Handy

viii. A teacher advised his students to always submit their work *on time*. What does the phrase *on time* mean?

A. Within arranged time

B. At exact time

C. Before the required time

D. One minute before time

E. When time is up

ix. Shonzine said, *"I used to love my mother very much."* How would this statement be rewritten in the present progressive tense?

A. I love my mother very much

B. I am loving my mother very much

C. I was loving my mother very much

D. I loving my mother very much

E. I had been loved my mother

x. The forces they applied were of equal <u>strength</u>; they were advised to _____ their forces. Which of the following words correctly completes the sentence by adding the correct suffix to the underlined word?

A. Strengthening

B. Strengthen

C. Strenghenet

D. Astrenghen

E. Strengheness

2. Match the sentences in COLUMN A with the correct responses from COLUMN B by selecting the most appropriate match.

COLUMN A	COLUMN B
i. He would have passed the exam if...	A. She gets a visa.
ii. She will travel to Europe if...	B. They had trained harder.
iii. They could have won the tournament if...	C. He had studied well.
iv. The school will organize a trip if...	D. The company makes enough profit.
v. The baby will cry unless...	E. They contribute the required amount.
vi. The workers would have received bonuses if...	F. She is given enough money.
	G. He is not fed on time.
	H. They had played better.
	I. The weather is favorable.
	J. They meet the requirements.
	K. The government allocated enough funds
	L. She would be given enough time to settle her bill

SECTION B (54 Marks)

Answer **all** questions from this section.

3. (a) Supply the appropriate question tags for the following statements.

i. Someone had been singing a song.

ii. There are no clouds in the sky.

iii. He was playing football since afternoon.

iv. They seldom eat spicy food.

v. Few birds flew away.

(b) Correct the following sentences where necessary.

i. I will tell you when I will know it.

ii. He grew maize on a plain garden.

iii. That woman she is the best singer. She sang beautifully.

iv. It is unnecessary for you to complete this task.

4. Rewrite the following sentences according to the instruction given after each.

a) A dog was very small, but all the children loved it. (Begin: Despite…)

b) As soon as he entered the room, the lights went off. (Use: scarcely ….)

c) In spite of being weak, he runs a long distance. (Use: nonetheless ….)

d) They will have been watching the movie for two hours. (Change into interrogative sentence.)

e) My neighbors were dancing like clowns. (Change into future perfect continuous tense.)

f) We are going to score high marks in science test, Ali and Fatuma said. (Punctuate the sentence.)

5. (a) Change the following into active voice.

i. Was the letter being written by him?

ii. The water had been being drunk by them.

iii. You are requested to submit the report before Monday.

iv. I was given a new beautiful dress by Aisha.

v. Let the ripe mangoes be eaten quickly.

(b) Complete the following sentences. The first is given as an example.

A daughter of your sister or your brother is your niece.

i. A daughter of your brother or your father is your _____.

ii. A young brother of your father is your _____.

iii. If you are a boy, all your aunts and uncles will call you _____.

iv. A daughter of your mother whose father is not your father _____

6. (a) Using different appropriate patterns, give your personal opinions on each of the following isssues.

(i) School rules

(ii) Corporal punishment

(iii) Family life education

(iv) School routine

(v) Rural life.

(b) The following sentences express on -going activities. Rewrite them into a negative form.

(i) I am watering flowers

(ii) They are cutting trees

(iii) The wind is blowing the fire.

(iv) You are reading a big book.

7. Complete the following sentences using phrases from the list in the box below. You can change the tense where necessary.

Phrases: Look after, turn down, put up with, run into, carry on, get over, take off, fill out, come down with, set out, and look up.

a) He lost his wallet yesterday, so he had to _____ the police report.

b) The manager decided to _____ the meeting due to the heavy rain.

c) She had a cold last week, and now she's finally starting to _____ it.

d) We were supposed to _____ early, but the car broke down.

e) It's difficult to _____ his constant complaining.

f) I need to _____ the meaning of this word in the dictionary.

g) He was surprised to _____ his old friend at the supermarket.

h) The plane is scheduled to _____ at 3 PM.

i) They decided to _____ the party despite the bad weather.

j) The nurse promised to _____ the patient's wound.

8. (a) Usually prepositions have a number of uses. Construct one sentence in each of the following expressions to their uses.

a) To indicate direction of movement

b) To show the relationship between a part and a whole

c) To denote the time when something happens

d) To show possession

e) To indicate a method or means

(b) From these words show which one comes first in the dictionary then write it in your answer sheet.

(a) Quiet and quite (b) Write and right (c) Break and brake (d) There and their

SECTION C (30 Marks)

Answer two **(2)** questions from this section. Question number **nine (9)** is compulsory.

LIST OF READINGS FOR QUESTION 10-11

NOVELS AND SHORT STORIES

A Wreath for Fr. Mayer	-	S.N. Ndunguru (1977), Mkuki na Nyota
Unanswered Cries	-	Osman Conteh, Macmillan
Passed Like a Shadow	-	B.M Mapalala (2006), DUP
Spared	-	S.N. Ndunguru (2004), Mkuki na Nyota
Weep Not Child	-	Ngugi wa Thiong'o (1987); Heinemann
The Interview	-	P. Ngugi, (2002), Macmillan

PLAYS

Three Suitors: One Husband	-	O.Mbia (1994), Eyre Methuen
The Lion and the Jewel	-	W. Soyinka (1963), OUP
This Time Tomorrow	-	Ngugi wa Thiong'o (1992), Heinemann
The Black Hermit	-	Ngugi wa Thiong'o (1968), Heinemann

POETRY

Songs of Lawino and Ocol	-	O. P'Bitek (1979), EAPH
Growing up with Poetry	-	D. Rubadiri (ed) (1998), Heinemann
Summons	-	R. Mabala (1960), TPH

9. Explore how two poems illustrate societal misconduct and discuss the relevance of these portrayals to contemporary society. Provide three examples of misconduct from each poem."

10. Many believe children are a gift, deserving of guidance, basic needs, and rights. However, some parents neglect these responsibilities, leading to adversity for their children. How do two novels you have studied validate this perspective? Provide three supporting details from each novel."

11. Playwrights often utilize central characters to convey their intended messages to the audience. Analyze how two main characters from two different plays serve as vehicles for the playwrights' messages. Provide three points of analysis for each character."